

accessories. With Outlook 2007 onboard mail syncing is as easy as apple pie, no!-easier.

At Rs 30,990 the HTC Ty TN II is frankly overpriced by a good bit. At a price point of Rs 24,000 or thereabouts this phone makes serious sense for business users. Its advantages include solid build quality, and a top list of features and application support, and a full, functional keypad.

ASUS M930

A little flash and little else...

The M930 drops WM6 Professional in favour of the lower flavour i.e. WM6.0 Standard, which is built ground up to support non-touchscreen devices. Also office document creation is dropped in favour of document reading and editing, and even these editing options are lighter than the Professional version. So the M930 is more a smartphone than a PDA. It's well built right down to the excellent hinge for opening the device to reveal a full QWERTY keypad. This keypad is decent, and exudes good feedback, but the size of the internal screen is what annoyed us—a miserly 2

inches, a shame when you look at all the space wasted inside with a fancy but useless screen bezel. The external screen is larger (2.6 inches) and has a proper, well laid out number keypad. On another note this 'smartphone' is good looking, and the finish quality is excellent. QWERTY keypad lighting is also top notch. A bundled business card scanner software and Voice Commander 2.0 add some seriously needed value.



ASUS M930

Camera quality and music playback quality are strictly so-so. Signal quality is good, but there are better options available.

ASUS builds some great PDAs. They also build some truly great looking smartphones. This one falls into the latter category—a smartphone, with some PDA capabilities, owing to its full keypad and WM platform. Seriously, straddling a divide between beauty and functionality in the business segment is not easy. This phone may appeal to a businessman, or it may not—depending on exactly what kind of a PDA phone he wants. Hardcore WM users will look elsewhere, at the HTC Ty TN II, which compared to the M930's price of Rs 27,900, starts to make a really sweet deal. If you want something PDA-like and flashy as well then the M930 may be worth checking out.

Samsung i780

This phone although good looking and well built from the front has a cheap plastic rear cover that spoils first impressions. For the rest its accessories are well built. Its got a decent screen (2.55 inches), and based around WM6 Prof. The QWERTY keypad on the Samsung feels good to use and the keys are nicely bevelled, if slightly close together, which makes typing longer emails easier. Full document creation and editing is supported, and Outlook 2007 makes emailing a snap.

On the multimedia front Samsung incorporates a 2 megapixel camera—which is pretty much defacto for cell phones/PDAs these days. In terms of performance we really liked the signal quality on i780, calls were quite clear, even in test zone 2, impressive and a much needed quality for a business oriented phone. Where the i780 seemed to lag was in terms of processing speed, although to be fair, it was no tortoise. At Rs 23,250 the i780 is a fully functional PDA. Our list of complaints includes



Samsung i780

a slightly larger screen, better built body panels, and a better software bundle. As it stands the phone is good, although a little overpriced for what it offers.

Palm Treo 750

A beautiful PDA

The Treo 750 actually looks exactly what a PDA should look like—when visualised in our minds eye. It's got that curvy body that looks hot while not ruining ergonomics one whit. The build quality is great, but not excellent. The finish is a rubberised matte, which wears well. The full QWERTY keypad actually works wonders with its excellent layout and intuitive feedback—you needn't bother about typing out even the longest email, and this will definitely be a point that corporate users will fall in love with. The Stylus is also top notch in terms of build, and combined with an excellent touch screen works well. The entire device is built to fit your hand well, and there's something very, very PDA-like about the Treo 750.

Palm now uses WM5.0 for their entire high-end PDA range and their own Palm OS for the cheaper PDAs. We have to say that WM5 works well on this Treo, although WM6.0 Pro would have



Palm Treo 750

been even better. The 2.6 inch screen is quite clear and a pleasure to work with, somehow the absence of a larger screen isn't so sorely missed here. Document creation and PDF reading are supported and Outlook 2005 makes mailing a no-hassle affair.

Now for the bad—no extra applications were bundled aside from those that are part of the WM5 install. On handsfree call quality is mediocre. We'd like WM6.0 Pro, and a slightly faster processor, and more inbuilt user memory (60 MB is downright insufficient). At Rs 22,990 the Treo 750 doesn't do anything irreparably wrong, but it could do a few more things right (mentioned above). As it stands, it's a mighty useful and functional PDA for business users.

Nokia E71

Lots of steel, but is it the real deal?

This was perhaps the most anticipated phone for us, and we couldn't wait to get hands-on after seeing the images. The E71 is excellently crafted of steel and alloys, and the front is finished in satin polished steel that gives a glass-like feel. The rear cover is pure steel, with some sort of surface treatment to resist oxidation and is dimpled for

aesthetics as well as to retain a firmer grip. The keypad feels a couple of notches lower in terms of build quality and although it's a QWERTY it isn't as well laid out, or as spacious as say the E61/E62. The screen is clear and crisp and smaller at 2.36 inches. The menu icons seem to have taken a Jurassic step backwards from what we're used to seeing on Symbian based phones. Another issue worthy of note is the pathetic keypad backlighting. On a positive note accessory quality is absolutely top notch.

In terms of features the E71 has very few rivals—GPS, WiFi, and an excellent 3.2 camera with autofocus, all this in addition to its decent PMP capabilities and good music quality. But document creation support is still absent, as is the joy of MS Outlook—which itself may be reason enough for corporate users to shy away. The keypad is another gripe—although we understand the need to keep the phone smaller than the gargantuan E61/E62, couldn't Nokia have spent a little more time designing the keypad to achieve a workable compromise? At a price of Rs 22,949 the E71 is a beautiful looking cellphone that may appeal to college goers and SMS junkies more than serious business users. It's well worth the dough you fork out, although it's far from a perfect PDA phone.

Motorola Maxx Q9

When bulldozers meet keypads

The Maxx Q9 follows its namesake when it comes to its dimensions—as a result of which it's really wide, and thicker than Nokia's E61/E62, which isn't very comfortable unless your palms



Motorola Maxx Q9



Nokia E71

are as large as small buckets. The build quality is so-so, with metal mixed with plastic on the exterior. We didn't like the finish—rubbery matte black seems to be overdone here. Once again we encountered WM6 Standard, and once again we missed the touchscreen. The QWERTY works well, and although the buttons are well laid out, the feedback one expects from a full keypad is missing—and this makes typing a little harder. Still for longer documents and mails the Q9 shouldn't be too bad. As mentioned before document creation and advanced editing is sorely missed from WM6.0's Standard version.

It's got a camera that is functional, no more, and the multimedia playback not so good, due to the screen which we feel is a let down, both in terms of screen size, and picture quality. Audio quality was also below par. One saving grace was the call and signal quality which was acceptable (if not good). At Rs 20,270 the Motorola Maxx Q9 isn't a recommendation worthy of anyone looking at a serious business device. Its limited potential in the entertainment realm is enough to bar all recommendations as a multimedia cell phone either.